

MOAR

Platforms: Xbox One, Microsoft Windows
Price: Xbox One & PC: ₹3,999
Reviewed on: Xbox One
Developers: Playground Games
Publishers: Microsoft Studios

Pros:

- Beautiful visuals
- Fun and immersive gameplay
- Great sound
- Large roster of cars
- Deep customization options

Cons:

- None



Coming to the sound that matters – the cars, they sound breathtaking. The game opens with you driving a Lamborghini and the opening sequence sets the stage for what to expect from the game. I have the Klipsch Promedia 2.1 speakers and a pair of HyperX Cloud Revolver headphones. I had no idea my speakers could sound this good. From the revving of the engine to something as simple as drifting, the sound of the game is unique and immersive. Add to it the fact that you have a bunch of radio stations that you can acquire to be a part of the festival, and you get a catalogue of background music and radio stations that can give GTA V a run for its money.

Gameplay

The beauty of Forza Horizon 3 is that the game is aimed at everyone. If you are new to driving games, you can switch on all the possible assistants and have a good time. I put the controller in the hands of people that aren't gamers with all the assis-

stants on and saw them actually have fun. There is also a custom option where you can have specific assistants on based on your play style. From traction control, manual shifting to manual breaking, you can really customize the way you play the game. There is incentive in switching off the assistants. The fewer assistants you enable, the higher will be the points you get at the end of each race.

Since the game is so vast you have a virtual assistant at your disposal at all times. The virtual assistant works in the same way we have seen Google assistant. It will direct you to your next objective, tell you the closest race, so on and so forth. It's a nice touch especially if you feel clueless and want to know what to do next.

Coming to the core gameplay, there is only one qualm I have with it. The tracks that you race on may feel very slim at times. The roads aren't as wide at times as I am used to. This isn't a major hindrance, but just something that caught my eye. As far as driving is concerned, the cars handle very well. If you want to play as a "beginner" you can feel how simple the cars feel to control, especially when you switch of assistance and want the car to drive like it really wood. This will enable a larger audience of gamers who want to play a proper racing simulator. Every car has its own handling from off-road-

ing buggies, to sports car and MUV's. Another interesting aspect of the gameplay is the sheer number of things

you can do while navigating from one end of the map to the other. On your way to a race you may come across a special PR activity that can help you get followers, find a driver to challenge or come across an exhibition race. You get the feeling of unlimited activities at your disposal at any given point in time. The game is quite lenient with what it offers. Even if you drift and destroy property you get destruction points adding to the overall "total points" in events.

Drivatars have been a part of the Forza family for quite some time and it's an interesting change when compared to racing against AI. You also get a log which shows you how your friends performed in the game adding a sort of co-op flavour offline gameplay.

Overall, Forza Horizon 3 has a lot to offer when it comes to gameplay, with a roster of 350+ cars, customization and tuning options, the ability to upgrade the cars, and more.

Verdict

Overall, Forza Horizon 3 is a fantastic game for amateurs and racing enthusiasts alike. The graphics of the game are breathtaking and prove what the Xbox One is capable of, if a developer really delves deep into the system. The sound design will make you appreciate your expensive headphones or speaker system. The sheer volume of things that you can do in the game will keep you hooked for a long time. A must have, if you are an Xbox One owner and enjoy playing racing games. *